Awbeh and Chisht-i Sharif and elsewhere in the eastern reaches of Herat Province, Franke and Urban's rigorous surveys in 2004–2006 are still useful. This work brought to light seventy-three previously undocumented structures, more than half of which lie in Chisht district. Nearer to Herat "large sacral buildings" (Franke and Urban 2006: 6) – e.g., the Gunbad-i Shohada and other *ziyarat*s, shrines, and mosques – are numerous, but they decrease steadily farther east: the east–west corridor along the Hari Rud, south of Chisht, is peppered with what appear to be fortifications and/or surveillance structures, including single towers (e.g., Kushk, Burj-i Qaria-yi Dehran, Dara-yi Takht) and small complexes (Qala'-yi Sarkari, Rabat-i Chawni), all in all not unlike the architectural landscape of southern Ghur (cf. also Chapter 4, below, and *infra* in main text). My own brief survey of areas west of Herat toward Ghuriyan (2011) also revealed single towers and small complexes. Altogether, these new findings demonstrate that areas other than central–southern Ghur also evinced clusters of similar structures, though the dating of *all* examples is still uncertain. See also Thomas 2018: 120–124. But given the prominence of nomadic populations throughout Afghanistan's history (cf., e.g., Dupree [1997] 2012: 57–65), the remains possibly evoke shared historical patterns where earlier fortification- or tower-strewn landscapes remained in enduring use by various populations over time (see also Chapter 3).

37. Intriguingly, Juzjani (vol. I, 1963: 328 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 317–318) provided a subtle hint that southern Ghur's terrain was well-fortified by the ninth century: evidently when the Saffarids emerged from Sistan onto a larger stage, for our purposes reaching the region of al-Rukhkhaj, "the tribes of the Ghuris fortified themselves on the summits of the rocks, and remained in safety; but they used to be at constant enmity with each other … keeping up a war from *kushk* to *kushk* …" Juzjani's only utilitarian regard of architectural remains, and complete *dis*regard of their chronology – typical of most textual sources – makes it difficult to know to which specific *kushk*s he referred, or their dates. Cf. Chapter 3, for a discussion of the term *kushk*, and more generally the pre-modern receptions of architecture in the Persianate-Islamic world. As a historiographical reflection, Juzjani's usage of material culture primarily as backdrop throws into even higher relief the present work's focus *precisely* on these elided historical indices, laying bare the very different methods of recapturing the past in modern times.
38. Although the "dwelling tower" was identified as characteristic of Sistan (Fischer 1970: 485), it serves to describe many of Ghur's individual towers, which also likely functioned as part-time residences (see main text). Overall the survey and documentation of Sistan by K. Fischer and his colleagues in the 1960s–1970s is relevant to our analysis of southern Ghur, not least because the non-sedentist lifestyles prevailing among the region's inhabitants effectively blurred strict lines of delineation: akin to southern Ghur, Fischer documented many ruined fortifications and individual towers throughout Sistan, though pointedly noting that there were certain building types he considered regionally specific to it, along with the technique – especially in towers – of combining the mud-brick structure with decoration in burnt or baked